

could die was certainly there in her head. So I told her about the will, told her who the guardians were, told her where the document was kept.

I told her that there would be enough through insurance covers for her future. Growing up in a financially aware household like ours, she knew the basics already and tucked away the information and got right back to the shake and the pizza. Luckily for all of us that will was never used. A new one has taken its place now that she is no longer a minor.

Not making a will reflects the biggest wonder of this world – we see people dying all around us; yet we believe that we are immortal. Some people consider it bad luck, some think you are tempting fate, and others just are convinced that they will not die anytime soon.

Whatever your reason, understand the fact that ***not making a will will tick the ‘most-selfish-thing-I’ve-ever-done’ box in my book***. You’re leaving behind a mess for your family, especially if there are joint assets with an extended family or you have created assets with your parents, making your siblings an heir to the property you thought you were leaving to your kids. Let’s get some basic myths out of the way.

Why make a will, my assets will go to my family

If you die without a will, your house, gold, car, mutual funds, jewellery will go to your legal heirs. Who the legal heirs are depend on your religion in India and which personal law applies to you. For example, if you are a Hindu, and die intestate (without a will), your assets will be divided equally among Class I heirs. There is a list of twelve relations that fall in this category, including sons, daughters, surviving spouse and mother.

Things get complicated when there are joint assets in the extended family, especially in real estate. Just writing down how you want your assets to be distributed solves a lot of the post-death trauma to the family. Second-guessing what you wanted to do after you are gone is an unfair burden you place on your family.

Why make a will, my kids won’t fight over my assets